

5.1 Top causes of water scarcity

Instructions: Draw a line to match the cause of water scarcity on the left to its definition in the middle column. Then draw a line from the definition to the example of this cause of water scarcity on the right.

Cause of scarcity	Definitions	Example
Climate Change	Rapid growth of cities that increases water demand and puts pressure on existing water supplies and infrastructure.	Farmers use open-channel irrigation that loses water to evaporation, reducing the amount left in local rivers.
Pollution of Freshwater Sources	An increase in the number of people using water, which raises demand beyond what local water supplies can provide.	A factory dumps waste into a river, making the water unsafe for drinking or irrigation.
Population Growth	Large amounts of water are needed for crops and livestock; inefficient irrigation or farming practices can use more water than the environment can replace.	A region becomes hotter and receives less rain, causing rivers and reservoirs to shrink.
Agricultural Demand	Long-term changes in temperature and weather patterns that reduce rainfall or increase evaporation, leading to less available water.	A rural village has a nearby river but no investment in pipes or pumps to bring the water to residents.
Poor Water Management Infrastructure	Removing groundwater from underground aquifers faster than it can naturally refill.	Wells in a farming region run dry because too much water was pumped for irrigation.
Economic and Political Factors	Old, damaged, or poorly planned water systems that waste water through leaks or fail to deliver it effectively.	A growing metropolis uses more water than its reservoirs can supply, causing seasonal shortages.
Over-extraction of Groundwater	Contamination of rivers, lakes, or groundwater by chemicals, waste, or harmful substances that make the water unsafe to use.	A fast-growing city struggles to supply enough drinking water to its expanding population.
Urbanisation	Lack of funding, weak government policies, conflict, or inequality that prevents people from accessing available water.	A city loses large amounts of water through leaking pipes before it ever reaches homes.